

That is a great question to ask as an engineer. The short answer is: **Yes, absolutely.**

While big companies like Bitly or TinyURL already exist, building your own version—especially with the **Smart** features you added—is a major milestone for your career for several reasons:

1. Solving Real-World Problems

In a professional setting, long URLs are a nightmare for marketing, SMS, and QR codes.

- Your tool makes links **shareable** and **trackable**.
- The **Custom Slug** feature you built allows for branding, which is exactly why companies pay for premium link-shortening services.

2. Mastering "The Big Three" of Backend Dev

Most student projects use just a database. You used **three distinct layers** of architecture:

- **Persistence (PostgreSQL):** For long-term reliability.
- **Speed (Redis):** For high-performance redirects.
- **Idempotency (Smart Logic):** For a professional user experience.

3. A "Recruiter-Ready" Portfolio Piece

When you interview for companies like **Deloitte** or **Oracle** (since you already have their certifications), they won't just ask if you know C++ or Java. They will ask:

"Tell me about a time you handled a system crash or a logic conflict."

Now you have a real story to tell:

- "I handled database conflicts by implementing idempotent logic."
- "I deployed a containerized app to the cloud using a CI/CD pipeline."
- "I optimized redirect speeds by implementing a Redis caching layer."

4. Cost and Control

By hosting this yourself, you own the data. If you were a business owner, you wouldn't have to pay \$30/month for a "Pro" Bitly account because you built your own for free.